MIRACLE OF HEADINGLY



INTRODUCTION

23 August 2019,
Ashes ke teesre test ka dusra din.
Headingly mein ho raha woh match ek normal match sa lag raha tha. Us din pe aaya hua English Crowd was happy kyuki England ne already Australia ko pehli innings mein 179 pe all out kar diya tha. But jaha pe England ke players and fans pe confidence pe tha wahi pe Australia ke players ne kuch umeed jagah di thi kyuki England bhi 24/3 thi din ki shuruwaat se pehle. Woh din shuru hota hai, aur pure stadium mein bas ek hi fanbase chilla raha tha, kyuki jitni tagdi us Ashes ka level tha, utni hi tagdi Australia ki bowling bhi thi. Lunch khatam hota hai aur England already 67 pe hi all out ho chuki thi . Aakhri din aate aate England woh almost haanre wali thi jab 4th innings mein world champions England ko 73 runs aur chaihye the aur ba 1 wicket aur chaihye tha. England toh chood even Australia ko bhi beleive nahi ho raha tha ki ek host team etna bekar kaise khel sakti hai. Ek woh din tha aur ek aaj ka din tha ki jo us test match ke baad hua woh aaj bhi test cricket ke itihaas mein baar

baar repeat karaya jaata hai. Yeh baat hai us iconic test knock jisne us match ko nahi balki us infamous Australia vs England rivalry ko wapas se iconic bana diya. Yeh baat hai tabki jab hame Benjamin Stokes ka 2nd name pata chala tha - CLUTH !!!!!!

PRE MATCH SCENARIO

Ab agar hum us match se pehle ke scenario ki baat karein, toh situation England ke liye utni achhi nahi thi jitni log soch rahe the. England aur english cricket ke liye sabse iconic event ho chuka tha jab kuch mahino pehle woh ek dramatic manner mein 2019 ka world cup jeet ke aa rahi thi. England ke itishaas ka pehla world cup aur us team ka confidence maano aasman choo raha tha. But as we all know jaha baat aati hai test cricket ki.....My friend anything can happen in the deadliest format of the game. Aur jab saamne ho Australia and dau pe ashes ki trophy lagi ho toh pressure aana toh laazmi hai.. Australia, jinke top players Steve Smith aur David Warner sandpaper bans ke baad wapas aaye the, unka focus sirf ek cheez pe tha — Ashes jeetna. Kyuki jitna critism unhone pichle ek saal mein jhela hai , even is tour ke starting mein bhi jis tarike se English fan unhe boo karne wale the aur smith ko sandpaper dikhake disrespect karne wale the. English fans had no idea ki woh kin players ko uksa rahe hai. Because initial tests mein Smith no England ke saath kiya hai, woh fans ko regret hi nahi balki ek liflong trauma mein daal deta hai.

Pehla Test Edgbaston mein hua jaha Steve Smith ne apne comeback pe 144 runs ki ek shandaar paari kheli aur England ke bowlers ko poora thaka diya. James Anderson, jo England ke sabse senior bowler the, match ke first day pe hi injured ho gaye the, jiski vajah se yeh series ab England ke liye aur mushkil hote hue dikh rahi thi. Is injury ne England ke bowling attack ko kaafi weak kar diya. Australia ne woh Test jeet kar 1-0 ki lead le li jisme Smith ne ek aur baar 2nd inning mein century lagai. World cup winning side ab bas Steve Smith ke

redemption ka shikaar bante hue nazar aa rahi thi. Jitni umeed fans ne World champions england se lagai thi , woh saari first test ke baad badalti hui dikh rahi thi.

Doosra Test Lord's mein tha and it was no different . Steve Smith aur Marnus Labuchagne ne na keval ek sustaibale innings kheli, but us match ko jo Australia almost haarne wali thi use draw kara diya. England ke batting line-up, specially top order, poore series mein struggle kar rahe the. Jason Roy, Joe Denly, aur Rory Burns consistent runs nahi bana pa rahe the. Jaha pe ek taraf Joe Denly aur Rory Burns ne proper 20 test matches bhi nahi khele the , vahi pe hamare white ball specialist Jason roy ki toh yeh pehli series thi.
Lekin phir series ka aata hai teesra Test Match. Headingley Leeds !
Ek match jisne us puri Ashes ko hi nahi balki Modern Ashes ke complete legacy ko hi redifine karke rakh diya tha. Jise execute karne wale aur koi nahi balki 2019 world cup final ke hero Ben stokes the.
Series ka third Test Headingley (Leeds) mein hona tha — aur yahaan England ke paas ek hi option tha, jeet. Agar woh match haar jaate, toh Australia 2-0 se aage jaata aur Ashes unke haath se nikal jaati. Pressure obviously bahut zyada tha. Team ke andar bhi sabko pata tha ki agar yeh match haara toh criticism aur badega.
Is time pe Ben Stokes ke upar sabse zyada expectation thi. World Cup final ke baad unka image ek "national hero" jaisa ban gaya tha. Lekin Test cricket mein woh form continue kar paayenge ya nahi, yeh sabko dekhna tha. Dressing room ke andar bhi Ben Stokes sabse focused player dikh rahe the. Reports ke mutabiq woh apne practice sessions mein sabse last tak nets mein rehete the, aur poora concentration red-ball game pe shift kar rahe the.
Australia ki team ke paas ek solid pace attack tha — Cummins, Hazlewood, aur Pattinson. Saath hi Labuschagne ne Smith ki jagah perfectly fill kar di thi. Team ka confidence peak pe tha.

22 August 2019 ko jab Headingley Test start hua, tab dono teams ek alag mindset ke saath utari. Australia ke liye yeh ek mauka tha Ashes retain karne ka, aur England ke liye apni izzat bachane ka.
Match ke pehle hi day pe conditions cloudy thi, aur Headingley ka pitch seamers ke liye perfect tha. Australia ne toss jeet kar batting choose ki, aur England ne early wickets lene ki puri koshish kari. Jofra Archer ne phenomenal bowling karte hue Australia ko 179 pe all-out kar diya. Lekin jaha sabko laga ki ab England easy lead le lega, wahi team pehli innings mein sirf 67 pe all-out ho gayi.
Is moment ke baad pure England dressing room mein silence tha. Fans, experts, sabko lag raha tha ki yeh Test match ab haath se gaya. But a certain innings was about to come from a certain player....or NOT !

THE INNINGS !

Us match mein kuch important ho ya na ho lekin England ke recently bane world cup star “Ben Stokes” ka chalna behad hi zaruri tha. Agar 2 matches ki disappointment ke baad kisi player pe ashaaye lagaye jaa rahi thi, toh woh keval Ben stokes hi the. Aur maano agle match hi woh English fans ki umeedo par khade utre aur aisa perform kara, ki aaj tak bhi us performance ki baat karte log nahi thakte.
Toh kahaani ki shuruwaat hoti hai 22 August 2019 se, Ashes ka teesra test match aur Headingley (LEEDS) ke us ground pe dono teams test match khelne utarti hai. Jaha pe Australia lead ko badane ke liye match khel rahi thi, vahi England apne hi ghar par ijjat talash rahi thi. Test match ke shuru hote hi England ne underperform karna shuru kar diya aur 80% of test match mein Australia nee dominance dikhae rakha. Jaha Aus ne pehle innings mein keval 179 hi runs banai paayi thi, vahi England comeback karne ki bajaye mahez 67 runs banakar all out ho gayi. Match ka chautha din aate aate jo English crowd , England team ki comeback ki umeed kar rahe the, ab bas kai sawalon ke

saath hi bache the. Aur is sab ke zimmedaar Ben stokes ko hi banae jane walla tha kyon ki surkhiyo mein toh vahi the. Agar is sab ke alawa baat kare toh England us match ko almost haar chuki thi kyunki ab unhe 4th innings match ko jeetne ke liye 359 runs chaiye the aur almost 1.5 day ka khel bacha hua tha. Agar realistically baat kare toh Is sab ke baad ya toh england match ko jeet ti ya phir direct haar ka saamna karna padta, kyon ki itna zyada time ke baad draw ka koi option hi nahi tha. Lekin England tab bhi draw ke liye khelti hai aur 77 over baad phas jaati hai. 77 over baad England ka score keval 159 hi hua tha aur 5 wicket gir chuke the. Sabko lag raha tha ki England draw ke liye khel rahi hai is haalat ko dekh kar England match toh nahi jeetne wali. Lekin us time pe crease pe ek batsman abhi bhi khada hua tha aaur woh the "Ben stokes". Bhale hi stadium mein baitha har ek aadmi England ki jeet ki ummede kabki chood chuka ho, Lekin Ben stokes abhi bhi jeet ke liye khel rahe the aur aisi situation mein jaha England kabhi bhi all out hoke match ko haar sakti hai. Aur yahi hame Ben Stokes ki mental toughness batati hai ki ek cricketer mentally kitna tough ho sakta hai ki jab stadium mein choodo, pure tv media yeh maanke baith chuki thi ki England is point se kabhi bhi match haar sakti hai, lekin Stokes abhi bhi jeetne ki intention se batting kar rahe the. Match ka thrilling moment tab shuru hua jab match ke 116ve over mein Stuart Broad out ho gaye aur team ka score 286-9 ho chuka tha.
1 Wicket, bas 1 wicket aur Australia 2-0 se aage hone wali thi. Har Australian fan ab Ashes jeetne ke sapne dekh raha tha. Lekin unhe yeh nahi pata tha ki unke aur Australia ke jeet ke beech abhi bhi Ben STOKES khade hue the. Aur pressure situations mein Stokes kaisa perform karte hai, yeh hamne 2019 world cup final mein bakhubi dekha tha. Lekin jeet ke liye 72 runs aur chaiye the and sab khatam ho chuka tha.
[black screen pause]
Until hame yeh dekhne ko mila [stokes hitting 4 clip]
Headingley Final Day HIGHLIGHTS! | Incredible Ben Stokes Wins Match | The Ashes Day 4 2019

Ben stokes ek end pe khade reh rehke , reh rehke run banate gaye aur itni pressure situation mein na hi keval unhone apne carrer ki best century lagai, balki England ko ek historic jeet bhi dila di. Win predictor bhi confuse ho gaya tha ki aakhir England jeet kaisi sakti hai. Lekin us clutch innings khelkar Ben stokes ne undoubtedly Test cricket ke itihaas ki greatest knock khel di. Aur tabhi se Ben stokes ko clutch player kahle jane laga. Woh knock unki itini iconic thi ki 2019 ke khatam hone ke baad unhe unke total contributions ki vajah se ICC cricketer of the year bhi chuna gaya tha

Us Inning ne keval unhe world ke top all rounders mein darja diya balki yeh bata diya ki aap end tak England ya ben stokes ko discard nahi kar sakte hai. Temperament , Discipline aur Clutch moments se bhari hui yeh inning aaj bhi Ashes ki best innings maani jati hai.